



## AFTER

Winfield Scott's retirement in late 1861 helped trigger unprecedented changes in the size and scale of American warfare—and a new man eager to take his place.

### FLAWED SUCCESSOR

The **new general-in-chief** was [George B. McClellan](#), who had been unashamedly scheming to replace his elderly but still clear-minded predecessor. McClellan would prove to be a **flawed choice for the command**, combining a deficit in moral courage with arrogance. Yet he remained a talented organizer, and his background in railroad management matched his talent for **logistical organization**. His strategic concept for besieging the Confederate army was also fundamentally sound, even if he failed to execute it properly.

### GIANT ARMIES

Scott's retirement pointed the way forward to **armies of unparalleled size** that would now wage war across the continent. Future battles would be giant confrontations where, for example, a total of more than 113,000 men clashed at Antietam (see [The Battle of Antietam](#)) and more than 111,000 at Gettysburg (see [The Battle of Gettysburg](#)).